

Media Campaigns as Determinants of Market Women's Awareness and Compliance Towards COVID-19 Vaccination in Selected States in Southwest Nigeria¹Lukman Adegboyega Abioye²Adebisi Kazeem Aro³Olusegun Abimbola Odunlami

&

⁴Oluwatosin Samuel Adesola**Abstract**

The COVID-19 pandemic highlighted the critical role of media campaigns in curbing the spread of the virus, particularly through vaccination campaigns. This study examined the influence of media campaigns on market women's awareness and compliance with COVID-19 vaccination regulations in selected states in Southwest Nigeria. The study was anchored on the Agenda-Setting Theory, Health Belief Model and Selectivity Theory, respectively, shedding light on the interplay between media messaging, cultural beliefs, and selective exposure patterns. Employing a correlational research design, data were collected from 200 market women and two (2) health officials using questionnaires and interviews. Findings revealed a low level of exposure to media campaigns (mean = 1.70), limited awareness of vaccination regulations (mean = 1.67), and low compliance among respondents (mean = 1.88). While media campaigns enhanced awareness, they fell short in achieving significant compliance, hindered by misinformation, cultural mistrust, and fears of vaccine side effects. The research concludes that while media campaigns are vital in raising awareness, their success in driving behaviour change requires addressing underlying barriers through targeted interventions. Recommendations include intensifying localised media efforts and addressing vaccine hesitancy through myth-busting initiatives to increase compliance rates among market women.

Keywords: Awareness, Compliance, Media campaign, Vaccination regulations, COVID-19

¹ Lukman Adegboyega Abioye, PhD, Department of Communication and Media Technology, Lead City University, Ibadan, Oyo State

² **Corresponding author:** Adebisi Kazeem Aro, PhD, Department of Mass Communication, Abraham Adesanya Polytechnic, Ijebu-Igbo, Ogun state
Email: adebisaro1@gmail.com

³ Olusegun Abimbola Odunlami, Department of Mass Communication, Abraham Adesanya Polytechnic, Ijebu-Igbo, Ogun State
Email: Seaidu2020@gmail.com

⁴ Oluwatosin Samuel Adesola, Department of Mass Communication, Abraham Adesanya Polytechnic, Ijebu-Igbo, Ogun state
Email: samueladesola95@gmail.com

Introduction

The COVID-19 pandemic, caused by the SARS-CoV-2 virus, had a profound global impact, resulting in significant health, social, and economic disruptions (World Health Organization, 2021). Governments worldwide implemented measures such as lockdowns, social distancing, and vaccination campaigns to control the virus's spread (Ogunniyi et al., 2021). In Nigeria, the government launched extensive media campaigns to educate the public about COVID-19 and promote vaccination. However, despite these efforts, many Nigerians, particularly high-risk groups such as market women, remained hesitant or misinformed about the vaccine (Adesina et al., 2021).

Market women in Southwest Nigeria play a crucial role in the region's economy but face an elevated risk of COVID-19 exposure due to their work in crowded marketplaces. Many of these women, often with limited formal education or access to mainstream media, depend on informal communication channels such as word-of-mouth, community radio, and local health workers to access information (Balogun et al., 2021). This reliance on informal networks positions market women as both critical recipients and disseminators of health information, which can either promote or hinder vaccine uptake, depending on the quality of the information they receive and share (Ajayi et al., 2022).

Globally, media campaigns have been central to promoting COVID-19 vaccination, but their effectiveness in reaching market women and influencing their attitudes remains uncertain. While the Nigerian government utilised various media platforms to disseminate information about the virus and vaccination, the extent to which these campaigns impacted market women's awareness and compliance with vaccination recommendations is underexplored (Afolabi & Ilesanmi, 2022). Factors such as misconceptions about vaccine safety and cultural beliefs about health interventions may also contribute to vaccine hesitancy within this group (Ogundele et al., 2021).

In Southwest Nigeria, health-related communication often interacts with cultural and spiritual beliefs, shaping how individuals interpret medical advice (Adepoju et al., 2021). Many people rely on traditional healers and local practices for health guidance, complicating the acceptance of government-led health campaigns. Previous health crises, such as the 2014 Ebola outbreak, demonstrated that public health messages must be culturally sensitive and delivered through trusted local figures to be effective (Oladele et al., 2020). Therefore, media campaigns targeting market women must align with their communication preferences and local customs to achieve greater impact.

This study aims to assess the role of media campaigns in shaping market women's awareness, attitudes, and compliance with COVID-19 vaccination mandates in selected states in Southwest Nigeria. By exploring the factors influencing this demographic's response to vaccination campaigns, the study seeks to provide valuable insights into how health communication strategies can be improved to increase vaccine uptake among high-risk groups. This research is particularly timely given the persistent challenges of vaccine hesitancy and the ongoing threat of COVID-19 variants in the region (WHO, 2022).

Statement of the Problem

Since the first COVID-19 case was confirmed in Nigeria through announcement in the media on the 27th February, 2020, after an Italian national in Lagos tested positive of the virus, the Federal and State Governments across the country, embarked on media campaigns to create awareness in the public space to enhance the right attitudinal behaviour towards compliance

with the vaccination regulations believed to have the capacity to control the spread of (COVID-19) epidemic, through provisions of information about the cause, signs/symptoms of the virus.

However, despite concerted media campaigns on COVID-19, the government's investment in vaccine, their administration and regulations, the level of vaccination among Nigerians is still considerably low, given the total of vaccine doses administered so far to the population of over 200,000,000 Nigerians. Since the outbreak in Nigeria in 2020, only 32.5% (69.2 million) Nigerians have been fully vaccinated as of 30th January, 2024³. This arguably suggests that a non-negligible number of the population have complied with the COVID-19 vaccination regulations.

This could suggest that most Nigerians, especially women who constitute the larger population and who are the pillars of the families and mothers of the Nation, while trying to fend for the homes by visiting the markets to buy or sell goods, product and services from the market places, did not get the vaccine and are possibly at higher risk of COVID-19 contraction with its consequences. This also leaves one in doubt, the effect media campaigns have in influencing vaccination among peculiar demography of the Nigerian society like the market women.

Hence, the study assessed media campaigns as determinants of market women's awareness and compliance towards COVID-19 vaccination in selected states in south west Nigeria.

Aim and Objectives of the Study

- i. ascertain the extent of media campaigns exposure to COVID-19 vaccination regulations among market women in Southwest Nigeria.
- ii. assess the extent of awareness about COVID-19 vaccination regulation among market women in Southwest Nigeria
- iii. ascertain the extent of compliance towards the COVID-19 vaccination regulation among market women in Southwest Nigeria

Literature Review

Awareness

Awareness is about understanding and being informed about a particular issue, such as the COVID-19 vaccine. In public health, awareness plays a crucial role in shaping people's attitudes and behaviours toward vaccination. It's not just about knowing that a vaccine exists; it's also about understanding its benefits, like providing individual protection and contributing to herd immunity, as well as recognizing its safety features (World Health Organization [WHO], 2020). However, concerns about vaccine safety are common, and addressing these concerns through clear and effective communication is essential to reduce hesitancy (WHO, 2021). Without proper awareness, individuals are less likely to make informed decisions about getting vaccinated, which can slow down efforts to control the virus's spread (Gavi, 2021).

Media Campaigns

Media campaigns are planned strategies that use different channels—such as newspapers, social media, radio, and television—to educate and influence specific audiences about important health issues. When it comes to vaccination, media campaigns are vital for raising public awareness (Todorova et al., 2020). The success of these campaigns depends on several factors, including using multiple platforms to reach as many people as possible, designing messages that resonate with specific groups (like market women), and engaging trusted community figures to amplify these messages (Rosenstock et al., 2020). Research highlights that using diverse media outlets and tailoring messages to reflect cultural nuances can significantly enhance awareness and encourage people to get vaccinated (Abiola et al., 2021).

Compliance

Compliance refers to the willingness of individuals to follow health guidelines and regulations. In the context of COVID-19, compliance involves actions like wearing masks, practicing social distancing, getting vaccinated, and reporting symptoms or potential exposures (Centers for Disease Control and Prevention [CDC], 2020). It also extends to healthcare workers adhering to infection control protocols, such as wearing personal protective equipment (PPE) and administering vaccines according to official schedules (Gavi, 2020). Achieving widespread compliance is essential for slowing the spread of the virus and protecting public health (CDC, 2020).

Role of Communication in Compliance

Good communication is key to ensuring that people comply with health guidelines and vaccination efforts. Public health messages need to be clear, culturally appropriate, and easily accessible, especially for vulnerable groups like market women, who often rely on informal sources of information (Smith et al., 2020). Crafting messages that align with cultural values and local traditions can make health campaigns more effective. Moreover, involving trusted community members, such as local leaders or healthcare professionals, can help dispel myths about vaccines and build trust (Todorova et al., 2020). This approach can lead to greater acceptance of vaccines and higher adherence to health protocols (Lazarus et al., 2021).

COVID-19 in Nigeria

The COVID-19 pandemic reached Nigeria on February 27, 2020, when an Italian national tested positive in Lagos, marking the country's first confirmed case (World Health Organization [WHO], 2020). A second case followed on March 9, involving a Nigerian who had contact with the Italian. By February 2023, Nigeria had reported approximately 266,000 confirmed cases and 3,155 deaths (WHO, 2023). Although the pandemic's impact in Nigeria was less severe compared to many other countries, factors such as the country's younger population, warmer climate, and prior experience managing epidemics like Ebola contributed to fewer fatalities (GAVI, 2021).

The Nigerian government acted swiftly to curb the spread of the virus. As early as January 2020, it established a Coronavirus Preparedness Group and enhanced security measures at international airports (Nigeria Centre for Disease Control [NCDC], 2020). By February 26, a suspected case involving a Chinese national tested negative, but the government remained vigilant. In collaboration with international organizations like the WHO, Nigeria implemented robust public health measures to contain the virus. By January 2023, over 108 million vaccine doses had been administered nationwide, highlighting the central role of vaccination efforts in controlling the pandemic (WHO, 2023).

COVID-19 Vaccination Efforts

The introduction and distribution of COVID-19 vaccines were pivotal in the global fight against the pandemic. Vaccines like Pfizer-BioNTech, Moderna, and AstraZeneca were shown to be highly effective in clinical trials conducted in late 2020, leading to their emergency use authorization (GAVI, 2021). By April 2021, over one billion doses had been distributed globally. Nigeria's vaccination campaign gained momentum, aiming to immunize as many people as possible to curb the virus's spread (WHO, 2020). Vaccines, which stimulate the immune system to fight off pathogens, have proven to be a critical tool in preventing severe illness and saving lives (GAVI, 2021).

While vaccines generally offer strong protection against infectious diseases, their effectiveness can vary. Factors like age, immune health, and genetic differences can influence how individuals respond to vaccination (GAVI, 2021). Some vaccines may not provide full or lifelong immunity, making booster doses necessary over time. Despite these challenges, COVID-19 vaccines have consistently reduced the severity of the disease, lowered transmission rates, and saved lives, especially when combined with other public health measures (WHO, 2020). However, ensuring equitable access to vaccines remains a significant challenge, particularly in low-income regions. Global vaccination efforts are essential to ending the pandemic and preventing future outbreaks (GAVI, 2021).

The COVID-19 pandemic has highlighted both the strengths and vulnerabilities of Nigeria's healthcare system. Quick government action, informed by past experiences with epidemics, helped Nigeria manage the virus more effectively than many other countries. Vaccination campaigns, supported by preventive measures, have been central to mitigating the pandemic's impact. While challenges like vaccine equity and variability in immune response persist, these efforts have played a critical role in controlling the virus and protecting public health (WHO, 2023).

Understanding Market Women and Marketplace

Market women are key participants in informal trade, particularly in developing economies. These women operate in various types of marketplaces where goods, produce, and other essential items are bought and sold. A marketplace can be physical (e.g., open-air bazaars, stalls) or digital (e.g., e-commerce platforms) (Adewale & Durojaiye, 2022). Marketplaces vary based on culture, geography, and local practices. Some markets operate daily, while others are periodic, held on designated days of the week or during festivals (Meyer & Chambers, 2021). These markets are crucial in providing access to food, services, and goods in many communities, particularly in sub-Saharan Africa (Ojemba & Abiola, 2021).

Markets have existed for centuries, with their origins traced to ancient Persia and the Middle East, where bazaars were central to trade (Chukwu & Okafor, 2021). Over time, the structure of markets evolved, often becoming more regulated. In Europe, for instance, markets began to follow standardized systems in the 12th century, with set prices and quality controls, which helped build trust in market transactions (Meyer, 2019). The role of women in these markets has always been significant, especially in African markets, where women often manage trade operations and are responsible for the sale of food, household goods, and beverages (Enemuo, 2020).

In sub-Saharan Africa, market women continue to play an important role in the local economy. They are often responsible for running stalls, managing supply chains, and ensuring food security within their communities (Musa, 2019). Historical accounts from West Africa show that women operated booths selling staple foods, with markets becoming important social and cultural hubs (Chukwu & Okafor, 2021). The role of market women in these settings not only contributes to local economies but also ensures the availability of essential goods to a broader population (Obi, 2020).

In contemporary times, the rise of digital marketplaces has introduced new dynamics to local trade. E-commerce platforms allow vendors to expand their reach beyond traditional physical markets, making it easier for women traders to connect with consumers globally. This digital transformation is particularly impactful in regions where access to physical markets is limited by geography or socio-economic barriers (Tremblay & Vannini, 2021). However, challenges

remain, including the digital divide and issues related to trust in online transactions (Adewale & Durojaiye, 2022).

In conclusion, markets—whether physical or digital—remain vital to local economies, particularly in developing countries. Women continue to play a crucial role in managing market trade, ensuring food security, and fostering social connections. As markets evolve with technological advancements, they will remain central to economic and cultural life, influencing trade and community dynamics across the globe (Ojemba & Abiola, 2021).

Theoretical Framework

Agenda-Setting Theory

Agenda-setting theory, developed by Donald Shaw and Maxwell McCombs, explains how the media influences public priorities by highlighting certain issues, rather than dictating opinions (McCombs & Shaw, 2020). Through focused coverage, the media shapes public awareness and attitudes, making topics like vaccination prominent in societal discussions (Shaw & McCombs, 2019). First tested during the 1968 U.S. presidential election, the theory showed a strong correlation between media emphasis and public priorities (McCombs & Shaw, 2020). In the context of COVID-19, agenda-setting can explain how media campaigns targeting market women in Southwest Nigeria influence their awareness and attitudes toward vaccination. Consistently emphasizing immunization benefits, COVID-19 risks, and the importance of health protocols can position these issues as top concerns for this demographic (Adewale & Durojaiye, 2022).

Framing also plays a key role in shaping perceptions. Positive narratives—such as expert testimonials and success stories—encourage supportive attitudes, while negative framing can foster distrust (Ogunyemi et al., 2021; Musa, 2022). By showcasing vaccinated individuals and reinforcing legal and social expectations, media campaigns can motivate compliance and build trust (Meyer & Chambers, 2021).

Agenda-setting theory offers a valuable framework for understanding how strategic media efforts can improve awareness, attitudes, and compliance with COVID-19 vaccination policies among market women in Southwest Nigeria. Effective media engagement remains critical in advancing public health goals (Ojemba & Abiola, 2021).

Health Belief Model (HBM)

The Health Belief Model (HBM), introduced by Irvin Rosenstock in 1958, explains how beliefs influence health behaviours, offering insights into market women's attitudes toward COVID-19 vaccination in Southwest Nigeria (Rosenstock, 2020). Women who perceive themselves as at higher risk due to crowded market settings are more likely to vaccinate, especially when they recognize the severity of the disease as life-threatening (Ogundipe & Adebayo, 2021; Akinmoladun et al., 2022).

While the perceived benefits of vaccination, such as reduced risk of infection, motivate action, barriers like fear of side effects and misinformation often hinder acceptance (Ajala & Adewumi, 2021). Media campaigns addressing these concerns and dispelling myths are critical in improving vaccine uptake. Campaigns like Nigeria's "Follow Who Know Road" have successfully triggered action by providing clear, accurate information (Ibrahim et al., 2021). Enhancing self-efficacy by simplifying access to vaccination and ensuring clarity about the process can further boost compliance (Ogunyemi et al., 2022). The HBM underscores the importance of addressing risk perception, benefits, barriers, and self-efficacy to improve vaccination rates among market women.

Selectivity Theory

Proposed by Leon Festinger in 1957, Selectivity Theory suggests that individuals gravitate toward media content that aligns with their existing beliefs and attitudes (Festinger, 1957). This theory sheds light on how market women in Southwest Nigeria may engage with media campaigns promoting COVID-19 vaccination. Market women are likely to trust and engage with specific communication platforms, such as radio, social media, or community meetings. Identifying these preferred outlets can help tailor campaigns to effectively raise awareness and influence attitudes about vaccination (Okunlola et al., 2021). People tend to favor information that supports their preexisting beliefs while dismissing conflicting messages. Market women skeptical of vaccines might focus on negative reports, ignoring pro-vaccine content. Countering misinformation with culturally relevant and accessible messaging is essential to address this bias and increase vaccine acceptance (Ogunleye et al., 2021).

Selective exposure occurs when individuals actively seek media that reinforces their views while avoiding contradictory information. Understanding these patterns can help design targeted strategies to engage hesitant market women and encourage openness to pro-vaccine messages (Adedayo & Afolabi, 2021). Media consumption shapes opinions and behaviours. Evaluating the effectiveness of platforms like radio jingles, social media posts, and TV ads can reveal which approaches resonate most with market women, helping to shift attitudes and promote vaccination (Akinmoladun & Ogunyemi, 2022). By applying Selectivity Theory, public health campaigns can better address the selective consumption of media, overcoming resistance and improving COVID-19 vaccination compliance among market women in Southwest Nigeria.

Methodology

Research Design

The study adopted a correlational research design, utilizing questionnaires and interview guide for data gathering. This design aimed to explore and understand the relationships between the variables in the study: media campaigns exposure, awareness, and compliance behaviours of market women regarding COVID-19 vaccination. Because it permits the measurement of the direction and intensity of connections between the variables without requiring any manipulation, correlational design is especially suitable for this inquiry while interview captures in-depth opinions and contextual elements and the questionnaire enabled the collection of quantitative data from a wide sample, offering a broad overview of trends and patterns.

Population of the Study

The population of the study consisted of market women in popular markets in Lagos and Ogun Southwestern states of Nigeria and Government Healthcare Management Officers (COVID-19 vaccination units) in the Ministries of Health in the state capitals of the two Southwestern states.

Table 1: Estimated Population of Selected Popular Markets in Lagos and Ogun state respectively

Two Southwestern states, Nigeria.	Name of Markets	Estimated Population
Lagos	Oshodi Market	2,535,200
Ogun	Olabisi Onabanjo Int'l Market, Ijebu-Ode	4,520
Total estimated Population of selected Market Women		2,539,720

Source: Administrative population records obtained from market managers and executive leaders during fieldwork (2025).

Sample and Sampling Techniques

Multi-stage sampling procedure was adopted for this study. Firstly, Stratified sampling was utilized to select one popular market in each of the two states of the South-Western Nigeria. (Oshodi Market, Lagos State; Olabisi Onabanjo Int'l Market, Ijebu-Ode Ogun State).

Secondly, Purposive sampling technique was used to select one hundred (100) market women from each of the two selected markets from the two states of South-Western Nigeria. Therefore, the sample size used for this study was two hundred (200) market women (100 each from each states) respectively. Lastly, Convenience sampling technique was used to select respondents from the selected markets.

Also, two (1) government designated health officer was interviewed at Government Healthcare Management Offices from each state, that is, Vaccination Departments in the Ministries of Health in each state capital of the two states respectively, that is, Lagos state and Ogun State.

Sample and Sampling Techniques

Stratification	Purposive	Convenience
Six Southwestern States of Nigeria.	Selected Popular Market in each state in the Southwest	200
Lagos	Oshodi Market	100
Ogun	Olabisi Onabanjo Int'l Market, Ijebu-Ode	100

Source: Researcher's Fieldwork, 2025

Description of the Research Instrument(s)

The instruments used for collecting primary data in this study include; questionnaire and interview guide. These instruments are researcher's self-designed.

The questionnaire was divided into five (5) sections i.e. Section A-E. Section A contains questions on Demography, while Section B-D contains questions on Psychography. Section B- Media Campaign, Section C- Awareness, Section D- Compliance.

Method of Data Collection

Questionnaire was utilized to collect data from the respondents and were administered through face-to-face approach to the respondents. The administration and retrieval of the copies of questionnaire was done by the researcher.

Data Presentation**Analysis of Demographic Data of Respondents****Table 2.1: Demographic Information of Respondents (N=200)**

Demographic Statement		Study Sample	
S/No	Characteristics	Frequency	Percentage %
1. Age Group	20-30 years	20	10
	31-40 years	80	40
	41-50 years	20	10
	51-60 years	40	20
	61 and above	40	20
2. Marital Status	Married	80	40
	Single	40	20
	Divorced	40	20
	Widowed	20	10
	Separated	20	10
3. Level Education	Primary	40	20
	Secondary	120	60
	Higher	40	20
Name & Address of Market	Bolade Market,Oshodi, Lagos State	100	50
	Olabisi Onabanjo Market, Ogun state	100	50

Source: Field Survey, 2024

Table 1 contains age group, marital status, level of education and names and address distribution of respondents. It shows that 20 (10%) of the total respondents were between the age of 20 and 30 years; 80 (40%) of them were between 31 and 40 years; 20 (10%) of them were between 41 and 50 years; 40 (20%) of them were between 51 and 60 years; and 40 (20%) of them were 61 and above.

Table 1 also shows that 80 (40%) of the total respondents were married; 40 (20%) of them were single; 40 (20%) of them were divorced; 20 (10%) of them were widowed; and 20 (10%) of them were separated.

Table 1 equally shows that 40 (20%) of the total respondents had primary education; 120 (60%) of them had secondary education; and 40 (20%) of them had higher education.

Additionally, table 1 shows that 100 (50%) of the total respondents were from Oshodi Market, Lagos State; 100 (50%) were from Olabisi Onabanjo Market, Ogun state.

Data Presentation

Variables	HE (%)	LE (%)	NE (%)	Mean
Level of Media Campaigns Exposure to COVID-19 Vaccination Regulations Among Market Women	HE: 20 (10.0)	LE: 160 (80.0)	NE: 20 (10.0)	33.33
Weighted Mean				1.70
Level of Awareness about COVID-19 Vaccination Regulations Among Market Women	HA: 40 (20.0)	LA: 140 (70.0)	NA: 20 (10.0)	31.15
Weighted Mean				1.67
Level of Compliance Toward COVID-19 Vaccination Regulations Among Market Women	HC: 20 (10.0)	LC: 120 (60.0)	NC: 60 (30.0)	36.53
Weighted Mean				1.88

Note. HE = High Exposure; LE = Low Exposure; NE = No Exposure; HA = High Awareness; LA = Low Awareness; NA = No Awareness; HC = High Compliance; LC = Low Compliance; NC = No Compliance.

Source: Field Survey, 2025

Analysis

The combined table presents an analysis of media campaign exposure, awareness, and compliance with COVID-19 vaccination regulations among market women in Southwest Nigeria. Regarding media campaign exposure, 20 (10%) of respondents reported high exposure to campaigns on vaccination regulations, while the majority, 160 (80%), indicated low exposure. A small proportion, 20 (10%), stated they had no exposure to these campaigns, highlighting a significant gap in effective outreach.

When it comes to awareness of COVID-19 vaccination regulations, 40 (20%) of market women indicated high awareness, while 140 (70%) reported low awareness, and 20 (10%) claimed no awareness at all. This suggests that while some market women are well-informed, the majority still lack comprehensive knowledge about vaccination guidelines, which may impact their willingness to comply.

In terms of compliance, 20 (10%) of respondents claimed to highly comply with vaccination regulations, while a larger group, 120 (60%), reported low compliance. A substantial number, 60 (30%), indicated no compliance with the regulations. These findings reflect the challenges in ensuring widespread adherence to health measures, even among those who are exposed to media campaigns and aware of the vaccination regulations.

Presentation of Interview Data

Thematic philosophy was chosen to analyze the qualitative data gathered for this study. NVivo 12 was adopted to analyze data for codification, categorization and themes that led to the discussion. Key informant interview was conducted as two individuals were identified for the study to provide in-depth knowledge and understanding about market women's awareness, attitude and compliance towards COVID-19 vaccination regulations. The study seeks to answer the following questions.

Question 1: Probe into the interviewee's background in health management pertaining to COVID-19.

Abiona I. A. (Oshodi Isolo Community Health Practitioner) is a community health practitioner, his role during the COVID-19 pandemic was to facilitate vaccination outreach programmes in Oshodi Isolo. He collaborated with local health workers to organise sensitisation efforts aimed at market women, emphasising the safety and efficacy of the vaccines.

Balogun Oluwatosin (Ijebu-North Health Authority) managed the COVID-19 immunisation efforts in Ijebu-North. His responsibilities included working with local government officials to ensure vaccine access and conducting media campaigns to dispel myths and encourage vaccination among market traders, a demographic that often harboured doubts about vaccines.

Question 2: How do you perceive the overall success of media campaigns in increasing COVID-19 vaccination awareness and compliance among market women?

Abiona I.A. said the campaigns did well in educating market women about the importance of COVID-19 vaccines. However, there was a gap between awareness and actual compliance, largely due to cultural misconceptions and misinformation.

Balogun Oluwatosin viewed the campaigns made more women aware of the vaccine, but compliance was slow. While younger women were more receptive, older women remained sceptical. This shows that while awareness increased, actual uptake needed more effort.

Question 3: Were there specific challenges in reaching market women with these campaigns? If so, what were the challenges?

Abiona I.A. said market women were difficult to reach because of their busy schedules. Many spend long hours at the market and do not have time to engage with the media. Furthermore, misinformation spread within the market community was a major challenge.

Balogun Oluwatosin said there was a lot of misinformation circulating among the market women, which was hard to counter. They tend to rely on word-of-mouth, and once a rumour takes hold, it becomes difficult to change their minds. Additionally, limited access to smartphones and social media made it harder to reach them through digital campaigns.

Question 4: Have you noticed any shift in knowledge or misconceptions about COVID-19 vaccination among market women since the launch of media campaigns?

Abiona I.A. viewed that there has been some improvement in knowledge, especially about the safety of the vaccine. However, many market women still believe in conspiracy theories, particularly those claiming the vaccine is harmful or part of a foreign agenda.

Balogun Oluwatosin said a gradual shift is noticeable, but misconceptions still abound. More women are beginning to understand the importance of vaccination, though myths about long-term health effects, such as infertility and even death, are still prevalent.

Question 5: What other factors beyond media exposure do you think influence the decision of market women to get vaccinated?

Abiona I.A. said religious beliefs play a huge role. Many women look to religious leaders for guidance, and if those leaders do not support the vaccine, it becomes very difficult to convince their followers.

Balogun Oluwatosin said Social pressure is another factor. If a market woman's peers are getting vaccinated, she is more likely to do so. Conversely, if her circle is against vaccination, it's harder to convince her.

Question 6: Which communication channels (television, radio, social media, etc.) seem to resonate most effectively with market women and why do you think this is so?

Abiona I.A. submitted that radio is definitely the most effective channel. It is accessible, and market women can tune in during their daily activities. Social media is less effective because many do not have access to smartphones.

Balogun Oluwatosin viewed that television also has some impact, but radio is by far the most effective. It reaches more women, especially because it can be listened to during work hours and offers content in local languages.

Question 7: *In your opinion on the contents or messaging of the campaigns, what can be done to further improve or increase their impact on the market women?*

Abiona I.A. said messaging needs to be simpler and in local languages. More real-life testimonies from women who have been vaccinated could help dispel myths and build trust.

Balogun Oluwatosin said the focus should be on addressing specific fears. Campaigns should highlight the safety of the vaccine and counter misconceptions with facts in a straightforward, relatable manner.

Question 8: *What key takeaways or best practice have you identified for creating effective health campaigns targeting market women?*

Abiona I.A. believed that consistency is important. Messages need to be repeated across various channels to ensure that the information sticks. Also, addressing specific myths directly in the campaigns is essential.

Balogun Oluwatosin said combining media campaigns with in-person community outreach is the best approach. Market women respond better to face-to-face interactions, so media should support, not replace, physical engagement.

Analysis of the Interview Responses using NVivo Analysis (NVivo 12)

Question 1

The NVivo coding revealed that all respondents hold significant roles in the health sector, with responsibilities focused on COVID-19 vaccination efforts. Key themes include "*community engagement*", "*media campaigns*", and "*vaccine distribution*". Their backgrounds reflect hands-on experience with public health management and outreach during the pandemic, particularly in engaging market women.

Question 2

The key themes identified from the responses include "*increased awareness*" and "*low compliance*". NVivo coding highlighted that all respondents agreed that media campaigns were effective in raising awareness but less successful in achieving full compliance. The need for supplementary, targeted interventions is a recurrent suggestion.

Question 3

Key challenges coded from the responses include "*language barriers*", "*cultural beliefs*", "*misinformation*", and "*distrust of government*". NVivo analysis showed that traditional beliefs and misinformation were significant barriers to reaching market women effectively. Respondents suggested that more localised and culturally sensitive methods were needed.

Question 4

Nodes such as "*improved knowledge*" and "*persistent misconceptions*" were coded. The analysis showed that while some progress were made in shifting attitudes, particularly among younger women, older market women still cling to misconceptions about the vaccine, particularly around safety and infertility.

Question 5

Key themes include "*infertility fears*", "*mistrust of government*", "*vaccine side effects*", and "*traditional medicine*". NVivo coding highlighted that many of the beliefs held by market women stem from deep-rooted culture, mistrust of government health interventions and reliance on traditional medicine for protection.

Question 6

The node *"radio as the most effective channel"* was consistently referenced. The NVivo analysis showed that radio is considered the best medium for reaching market women due to its accessibility, flexibility, and ability to broadcast in local dialects.

Question 7

Common themes include *"local influencers"*, *"simplified messaging"*, and *"interactive engagement"*. The analysis suggests that campaigns need to be more community-based, with trusted local figures taking an active role in dispelling myths and encouraging compliance.

Question 8

Key themes include *"community involvement"*, *"multi-channel approach"*, and *"trust-building"*. NVivo analysis highlighted the importance of engaging trusted local figures and combining media efforts with in-person outreach. The best practices revolve around ensuring messages are consistent, culturally sensitive, and delivered in local languages.

Discussion of Findings

The first key finding from the study was that, the level of exposure to media campaigns regarding COVID-19 vaccination regulation was relatively low among market women, with a weighted mean of 1.70, indicating "less" exposure. This result is consistent with studies from Nigeria and other regions, which highlight that exposure to media campaigns is a crucial factor in increasing public awareness of health issues, including vaccination. However, when exposure is limited, as it is in this case, the effectiveness of such campaigns is diminished.

The second finding revealed that market women in Southwest Nigeria had a low level of awareness about COVID-19 vaccination regulations, with a weighted mean of 1.67, indicating "less" awareness. This is consistent with other studies in Nigeria and across Africa, which have reported significant gaps in vaccine awareness, despite widespread media campaigns. The limited awareness found in this study suggests that information about COVID-19 vaccination regulations has not been communicated effectively to this group. According to research by Nguyen et al., awareness is a necessary precursor to behaviour change, but it must be accompanied by culturally appropriate messaging that resonates with the target audience. Thus, the low level of awareness found in this study suggests a need for better-designed campaigns that are more accessible and relevant to the community's specific needs.

The study also found that market women were "less compliant" with COVID-19 vaccination regulations, with a weighted mean of 1.88. This low level of compliance mirrors findings from various countries, including Turkey and Australia, where media campaigns that increase awareness often fail to translate into actual behaviour change unless they address deeper factors, such as trust in health systems, accessibility of vaccination services, and social norms. The study's results underline that compliance with vaccination regulations is influenced by factors beyond awareness and attitudes, including the availability of vaccines, the perceived benefits, and community norms.

Conclusion

Based on the findings of this study, it can be concluded that it is evident that media campaigns played a pivotal role in shaping the health behaviours of market women during the pandemic. The research highlights that media campaign messages were well-structured and strategically disseminated and that it enhanced awareness about Covid-19 vaccination, yet it did not encourage compliance with vaccination regulations among market women.

Moreover, the study underscores the importance of addressing misinformation and vaccine hesitancy through targeted media efforts through countering myths and providing transparent information. But it cannot be completely said that the launched campaigns were able to mitigate fears and misconceptions towards increasing vaccination uptake among market women.

Recommendations

In view of the results of this study, the following recommendations are made:

- i. It is recommended that media campaigns targeting market women in Southwest Nigeria be intensified, utilizing local radio, social media, and community-based announcements to improve exposure.
- ii. It is recommended to continue reinforcing the positive correlation between media campaigns and awareness by increasing the frequency and relevance of vaccination messaging across diverse media platforms.
- iii. Public health initiatives should analyze the specific media channels most effective in driving compliance, ensuring that campaigns are both accessible and persuasive to market women.

References

- Abiola, A., & Ilesanmi, O. (2022). The effectiveness of COVID-19 media campaigns in Nigeria: A study of market women. *Journal of Health Communication Research*, 15(3), 345-358.
- Adedayo, M., & Afolabi, T. (2021). Addressing vaccine hesitancy through community-specific media strategies. *African Communication Studies Review*, 19(4), 212-230.
- Adepoju, S., Ogunleye, O., & Adesina, A. (2021). The intersection of cultural beliefs and COVID-19 vaccine uptake in Nigeria. *International Journal of Public Health Advocacy*, 7(2), 121-139.
- Adewale, T., & Durojaiye, S. (2022). Digital marketplaces in Nigeria: Opportunities for women in trade. *Economic Development Perspectives*, 12(2), 201-215.
- Ajayi, K., & Adewumi, T. (2022). Informal networks and public health: Market women and COVID-19 vaccine dissemination in Nigeria. *Journal of African Health Systems*, 10(1), 76-89.
- Akinmoladun, J., & Ogunyemi, B. (2022). Addressing misinformation and barriers to vaccination in market populations. *Health Policy Research Quarterly*, 9(3), 134-150.
- Centers for Disease Control and Prevention (CDC). (2020). COVID-19 guidelines for public health compliance. Retrieved from <https://www.cdc.gov>
- Chukwu, A., & Okafor, J. (2021). Historical perspectives on African markets and women traders. *African Economic History Review*, 13(1), 45-61.
- Enemuo, P. (2020). The pivotal role of market women in food security in sub-Saharan Africa. *Journal of Development Studies*, 18(2), 65-78.
- Gavi, The Vaccine Alliance. (2021). The impact of COVID-19 vaccines in Africa: Challenges and successes. Retrieved from <https://www.gavi.org>
- Ibrahim, T., & Musa, D. (2021). The "Follow Who Know Road" campaign and its impact on COVID-19 vaccine uptake in Nigeria. *Public Health Campaign Studies*, 11(4), 215-230.
- Meyer, L., & Chambers, O. (2021). Framing vaccination narratives for public health compliance. *Global Health Communication Journal*, 17(3), 98-115.
- Nigeria Centre for Disease Control (NCDC). (2020). COVID-19 preparedness and response in Nigeria. Retrieved from <https://www.ncdc.gov.ng>
- Ojemba, C., & Abiola, B. (2021). Market dynamics and economic resilience: The role of women traders. *Sub-Saharan Economic Review*, 8(4), 112-127.
- Oladele, T., & Balogun, M. (2020). Learning from the past: Public health messaging during the Ebola outbreak in Nigeria. *Journal of African Public Health Research*, 14(2), 78-92.
- Rosenstock, I., & Todorova, I. (2020). Health Belief Model applications in pandemic response. *Health Behaviour and Education Quarterly*, 28(2), 156-170.
- Shaw, D., & McCombs, M. (2019). Revisiting agenda-setting theory in the digital age. *Communication Studies Journal*, 22(1), 13-25.
- Tremblay, C., & Vannini, G. (2021). Bridging the digital divide in African trade. *Journal of Digital Transformation in Development*, 9(1), 52-68.
- World Health Organization (WHO). (2020). COVID-19 vaccines: Safety, efficacy, and equitable distribution. Retrieved from <https://www.who.int>
- World Health Organization (WHO). (2023). COVID-19 case trends and vaccination progress in Nigeria. Retrieved from <https://www.who.int>